I matter

I am loved

THE WORDS IN MY HEART

WOW

YOU'RE THE Best

You are doing GREAT!

I can make a difference

Grateful

Beautiful

Love

I believe in me

I am kind

I am brave

Blessed

I am beautiful

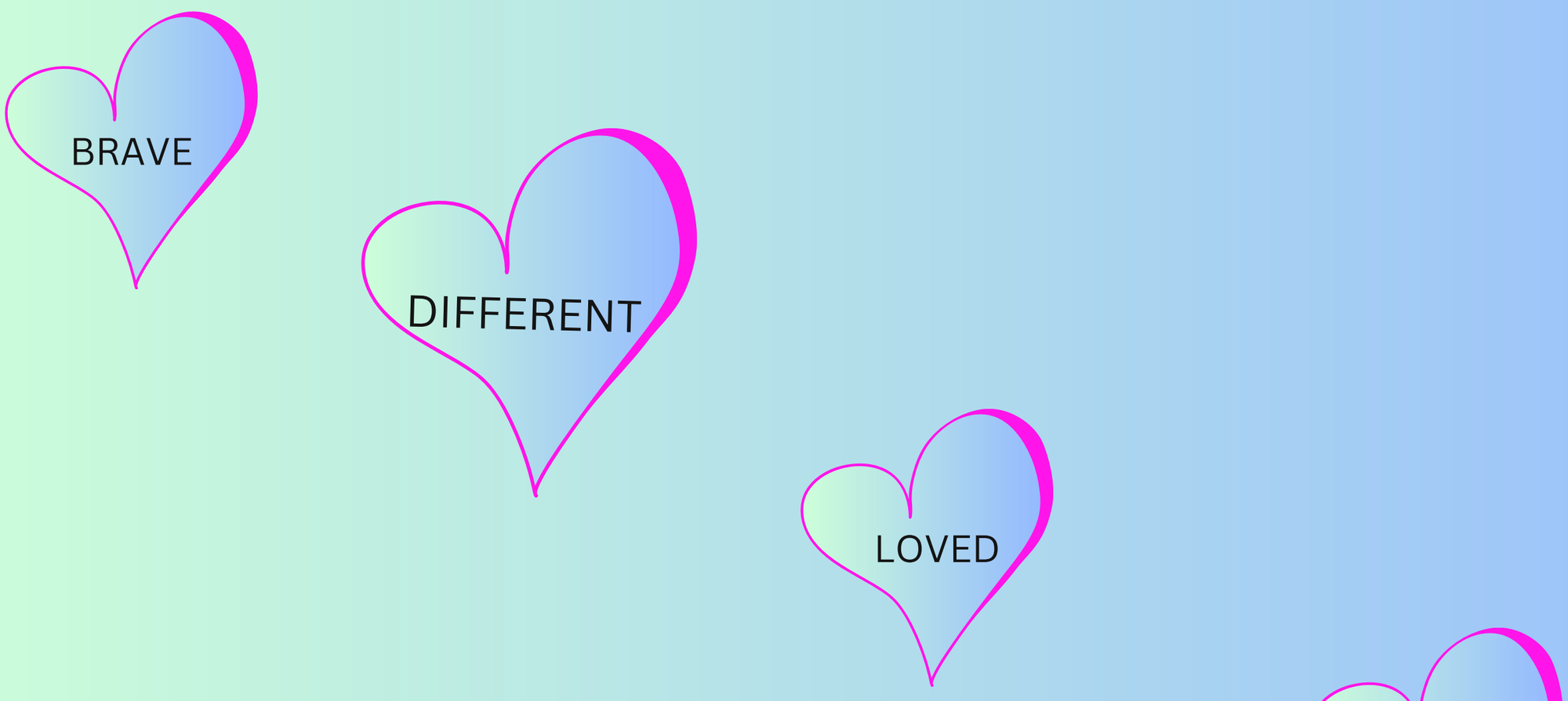
GRATEFUL

it's okay to feel your feelings

I am good

BELIEVE IN YOURSELF

The Words In My Heart



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disclaimer: These stories are based on Islamic teachings and are simplified for children.

Zayd was a kind and curious boy, always full of questions and stories. He loved sharing what he learned with his friends, but there was something that made it hard for him to speak—he stuttered. Sometimes, the words in his heart felt stuck in his throat, and no matter how much he tried, they wouldn't come out smoothly.

At school, when Zayd tried to speak in front of the class, some of the children would giggle or whisper behind his back. "Why can't you talk properly?" they would tease. Even though Zayd knew they didn't mean to hurt him, it still made him feel small inside. The more they teased, the quieter he became, until he no longer wanted to talk at all.

One evening, after a particularly tough day, Zayd sat alone in his room, feeling like no one understood. His mother noticed the sadness in his eyes as she passed by. She gently sat beside him and placed a hand on his shoulder.

"Zayd, my dear," she said softly, "What's been bothering you? You've been so quiet today."

Zayd looked down at his hands. He didn't want to say it out loud, but the hurt was too heavy to carry alone.

"Everyone makes fun of the way I talk," he said, his voice barely above a whisper. "I try to speak, but the words just don't come out right. Why can't I talk like everyone else?"

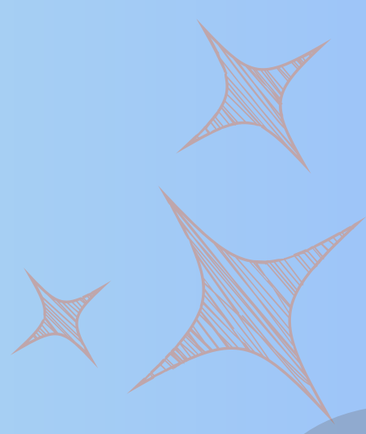
His mother's eyes softened as she pulled him close. "Oh, Zayd," she began, "Do you know that even one of the greatest prophets, Prophet Musa (AS), had trouble with his speech?"



Zayd looked up in surprise. "Really? Prophet Musa (AS)?"

"Yes," his mother nodded. "When Allah told Musa (AS) to speak to Fir'aun, Musa (AS) felt nervous because he wasn't confident in his speaking. He was worried that his words wouldn't come out clearly. But do you know what he did?"

Zayd shook his head, his eyes wide with curiosity.



"He made a special dua to Allah," his mother continued. "He asked Allah to help him. This is the dua he said:

رَبِّ اشْرَحْ لِي صَدْرِي
وَيَسِّرْ لِي أَمْرِي
وَاحْلُلْ عُقْدَةً مِّن لِّسَانِي
يَفْقَهُوا قَوْلِي

Rabbi-ishrah lee sadree
Wa yassir lee amree
Wahlul 'uqdatan min lisaanee
Yafqahoo qawlee

(Surah Taha 20:25-28)



It means: 'O my Lord! Open my chest and ease my task for me; and loosen the knot from my tongue so that they may understand my speech.'"

Zayd listened closely, repeating the words after his mother. There was something comforting about the dua, and for the first time in a long while, Zayd didn't feel so alone.

I am loved

"Do you see, Zayd?" his mother smiled. "Even prophets had moments of fear and worry. But Musa (AS) knew that Allah was always with him, and with Allah's help, nothing is impossible. You can make this dua whenever you feel nervous or unsure. Allah is always listening."

Zayd nodded, feeling a small spark of hope in his heart. That night, before he went to bed, he whispered the dua again, asking Allah for the courage to speak with confidence.

I am kind

Over the next few days, Zayd said the dua every morning. He said it when he was about to talk in class and when he felt nervous around his friends. At first, his stutter didn't completely go away, but something inside him began to change. Zayd started to feel more confident. He realized that it didn't matter if his words were perfect; what mattered was that he was trying, and Allah was with him.

One day, during class, Zayd raised his hand to share a story. He felt the familiar nervousness in his chest, but this time, he whispered the dua of Musa (AS) under his breath. As he stood in front of the class, his words came out slowly, but clearly. His classmates listened, and no one laughed or whispered.

I can make a difference

I believe in me

When Zayd finished, his teacher smiled and said,
"Thank you, Zayd, for sharing your story with us.
You did wonderfully!"

Zayd felt a warmth in his heart. It wasn't about speaking perfectly anymore. It was about knowing that he had the strength, with Allah's help, to speak the words in his heart. And that made all the difference.

From that day on, Zayd remembered the lesson his mother had taught him—just like Prophet Musa (AS), whenever he needed help, he could always turn to Allah.

The End

A Note from the Author

Dear Readers,

This story is especially close to my heart. Growing up, I struggled with stuttering, and I know how hard it can be to feel like the words in your heart don't come out the way you want them to. It can be frustrating, even painful, when others don't understand what it's like.

Now, as a mother, I see my own son walking a similar path. It's not always easy, but I've learned through my journey that our challenges don't define us—they shape us. Just like Zayd in this story, we have the power to seek strength through our faith. Allah listens to the words we speak, even when they aren't perfect. He knows what's in our hearts.

This story is a reminder for anyone who struggles with speech, or any other challenge, that you are not alone. Like Prophet Musa (AS), we can call on Allah for help, and He will always be there to guide us.

Speak with confidence, trust in your journey, and remember that your voice matters.

With love,

Faheema